

- 1: Aims and Ambitions
- 2: Nations between tradition and change
- 3: Saving the Planet
- 4: The impact of media on society

Means of transport instead of car, bike and underground

Structure: der wesentliche Aufbau des Textes, wie steigt Autor ins Thema ein?
Wie arrangiert er/sie die Argumente?

Use of language: auf Stilmittel eingehen, allgemeine Wahl der Wörter (positiv oder negativ?) und der Tonfall (ironisch, sachlich, emotional, besorgt)- faktenbasiert oder appelliert er an Emotionen d. Lesenden, berichtend oder argumentativ, Kontrast, imagery, Metapher, mood, similie, symbol

Communicative strategies: Wie versucht d. Autor von der eigenen Perspektive zu überzeugen? Werden Zitate von Expertinnen oder Betroffenen eingesetzt? Werden die Lesenden direkt angesprochen? Werden Beispiele oder Statistiken angeführt? Wie ausgewogen wird das Thema dargestellt?

In literarischen Texten:

- use of language: Stilmittel, Satzkonstruktion und Wortwahl im Allgemeinen(Ironic, sarcastic, depressing, dark, tense)
- **Narrative techniques:** Welche Erzählperspektive wird verwendet(third-person, first Person), wie werden die Figuren charakterisiert? Zeitsprünge?, Charaktere, Ironie, Erzähler, Point of View, stereotype, theme
- Cf statt vgl.
-

Kommentar	Erörterung
Eigene Meinung	Diskussion aus verschiedenen Perspektiven
Meist wird nur pro oder kontra beleuchtet	Verschiedene Bereiche (pro und Kontra)
4-6 Argumente	2-3 Argumente pro Seite
Eigene Erfahrung und Wertvorstellung im gesamten Text reflektieren	Argumentation erfolgt sachlich, erst im Schluss die eigene Meinung

Je nach Format (Zeitungsartikel- sachlich, blog- individuell) Sprache anpassen

Device	Explanation	Effect
imagery	Use of language beyond its dictionary meaning	To stimulate the imagination of the reader/ listener and to give him a new perspective on a topic to illustrate ideas
Metaphor	A comparison between two things which are quite unlike one another without using as or like	To stimulate associations, but stronger than a comparison or simile

Simile	Like a metaphor a type of comparison; uses the word like or as to compare two things	To stimulate the imagination of the reader and give them a new perspective
Personification	Technique of representing animals/ objects as if they were human beings	See above
Symbol	A thing or a word standing not only for itself but also for an abstract idea	See above
Enumeration	The listing of words or phrases in a text	Mostly to give details and intensify what is being said
Repetition	Use of a word or a phrase more than once	To underline sth.
Anaphora	Repetition of the same word or words at the beginning of successive sentence	Emphasis; creation of a rhythm
Alliteration	Repetition of a sound(consonant) at the beginning of neighbouring words	Produce a rhythm
Irony	Making fun of someone, often by saying the opposite of what one means	To make the reader start to think, to show distance towards a subject
Rethorical question	A question to which the answer seems obvious	to emphasize a feeling to show problems or a conflict to elicit the readers consent
Ellipsis	Incomplete sentences	To indicate state of confusion or emotion
Contrast	Opposing views words or characters are brought together	To emphasize difference and highlight opposite elements
Exaggeration	Strong overstatement	To create either a serious or a comic effect
Pum	A play on words that have the same or similar sound but different meaning	To create a comic effect
Direct speech	Direct quotation of what experts or normal people said	To achieve credibility an authentic or more lively effect
Quotation	Quotation from texts or authorities	To enhance credibility

1. Aims and Ambitions

Key ideas:

- Refers to personal goals in life (career, education, self-fulfillment)
- Influenced by factors like social background, education, gender, and opportunities
- Conflict between individual dreams and societal expectations

Important aspects:

- Motivation: intrinsic (passion) vs extrinsic (money, status)
- Barriers: inequality, lack of access, discrimination

- The role of hard work vs privilege

Useful arguments:

- Success depends not only on effort, but also on structural conditions
- Following one's ambition can lead to fulfillment, but also pressure and failure

Key vocabulary:

- to pursue a goal
- to achieve / accomplish
- upward mobility
- to overcome obstacles
- self-realisation

2. Nations Between Tradition and Change

Key ideas:

- Societies balancing cultural heritage with modern developments
- Tension between preserving traditions and embracing progress

Important aspects:

- Globalisation influencing lifestyles and values
- Generational conflicts (young vs old)
- Topics like migration, identity, cultural diversity

Useful arguments:

- Change can bring innovation, but may threaten cultural identity
- Traditions provide stability, but can also limit progress

Examples you can mention:

- Indigenous cultures vs modern society
- Urbanisation
- Role of technology in changing societies

Key vocabulary:

- cultural heritage
- social change
- to adapt / to preserve
- identity crisis
- multicultural society

3. Saving the Planet

Key ideas:

- Environmental protection and sustainability
- Major issues: climate change, pollution, loss of biodiversity

Important aspects:

- Causes: industrialisation, overconsumption, fossil fuels
- Responsibility: individuals vs governments vs corporations
- Solutions: renewable energy, recycling, sustainable lifestyles

Useful arguments:

- Individual actions matter, but systemic change is crucial
- Economic growth often conflicts with environmental protection
- Urgency: climate crisis is a global challenge

Key vocabulary:

- carbon footprint

- renewable energy
- climate crisis
- sustainability
- environmental awareness

4. The Impact of Media in Society

Key ideas:

- Media shapes opinions, values, and behaviour
- Includes social media, news, TV, internet

Important aspects:

- Positive: information access, education, connectivity
- Negative: fake news, manipulation, addiction

Critical points:

- Influence on democracy and public opinion
- Role of algorithms and filter bubbles
- Representation and stereotypes

Useful arguments:

- Media can both inform and manipulate
- Social media amplifies voices but also spreads misinformation

Key vocabulary:

- to influence public opinion
- fake news / misinformation
- media bias
- digital footprint
- echo chamber

The American Dream:

- means that everyone can achieve success through hard work, regardless of their background
- Society encourages people to „write their own life stories“
- However ambitions have also negative sides:
- Leads to strong competition
- Creates a constant search for status symbols (bigger this bigger that)
- People compare themselves and try to stand out more than others
- Stress and pressure to succeed, Materialism and overconsumption
- Disappointment
- freedom, individualism, mobility, helping weaker members, progress, hardworking, patriotism, optimism, flexibility, hard work, progress
- Today: social responsibility, helping weaker members
- Melting Pot: where foreign immigrants give up their national identity, culture, language and form a new nation- assimilation- multiculturalism
- Salad Bowl: fight against discrimination, influx of new ethnic groups who refuse to be culturally absorbed by American society made America create the concept to accepting America as diverse, multicultural and pluralistic - cultural coexistence- acculturation- kulturelle anpassung

Concept	Definition	Example
Stereotype (cognitive bias)	Assumption about a group of people who all share same characteristics positiv or negative	Teenagers are lazy
Prejudice (affective bias)	Belief about a group of people without knowing them personally, based on stereotypes usually	I hate yankee fans they all make me angry
Discrimination	When prejudice turns into action, treating somebody unfairly because of their group ect.	Whites only
Racism	Strong form of prejudice focused on race- one better than another	Kuklux Clan
Colourism	Treated differently based on skin color	

3. Between Traditions and Change

- Definition

Conflict between keeping cultural traditions and adapting to modern society

Causes of tension

Migration → people move to new cultures

Generational differences (parents vs. children)

Global influences (media, internet)

Typical conflicts:

Family expectations vs. personal freedom

Arranged marriage vs. love marriage

Gender roles

Identity issues

People feel “between two cultures”

Struggle with belonging

Opportunities

Cultural diversity

New perspectives and hybrid identities

4. Globalization

- Definition

Increasing worldwide connections (economy, culture, communication)

- Key aspects

Global trade (companies operate worldwide)

Fast communication (internet, social media)

Cultural exchange

- Advantages

More job opportunities

Access to goods worldwide

Cultural exchange and innovation

- Disadvantages

Exploitation of workers (cheap labor)

Environmental damage

Loss of local cultures

- Role of companies

Multinational corporations (e.g. Apple) influence global markets

- Global problems

Climate change

Inequality between rich and poor countries

Cultural appropriation- kulturelle Aneignung